Dan Dobrick

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Backend engineer with ten years in Ruby on Rails, currently owning payments on Shopify's billing platform, where I design cross-team systems that reach every merchant. I've been a technical lead since my first engineering job, including rebuilding brightwheel's education product and building its Marketplace from scratch. I run several AI coding agents in parallel to ship more, sooner, without sacrificing quality.

WORK EXPERIENCE

Shopify

Senior Software Engineer **Jun. 2024 – Present**

On a 7-engineer team running the billing platform that invoices and collects payment from every Shopify merchant (~$7B USD/yr), including PCI-scoped and internationally regulated payment flows. Own all payment methods and payment processing, including all India (INR) payments.

- Led cross-team delivery of on-session payments for Indian merchants: time-to-pay cut from ~30 hours to ~30 seconds; success rate raised from ~40% to ~60%, across ~400k merchants and ~$65M USD in India revenue. Convinced Razorpay to fix their token-authentication API rather than build the redirect flow they recommended, which would have meant rework across multiple systems. Built the dashboards (by gateway and session type) that measure it.
- Designed and shipped the billing platform's public GraphQL API, replacing a legacy proxy for most merchants and enabling role-based billing permissions for multi-store enterprise accounts.
- Migrated ~$100M/month of usage-based billing from integer to decimal precision with zero revenue impact across two services, proving equivalence with a production shadow comparison before cutover and removing a micro-unit workaround from every API client.
- Technical lead migrating Billing's credit card vault into the company-wide vault, the first step toward retiring a legacy card-payment flow. Built the cross-stack groundwork, including a gRPC client, Kafka consumers, and network-token support for Braintree and Stripe.
- Paused the migration after prototyping exposed a flaw in the original vault design, then redesigned payment-method ownership with the vault team, which also removes an org-wide payment-method fan-out.
- Frequently on call for the billing platform, and the go-to for payment incidents routed from other teams: triage, root-cause, and fix payment-correctness problems in production.
- Mentor a frontend-focused engineer who now ships backend changes independently, and regularly pair with and give code feedback to peers.
- Run 3–6 coding agents concurrently across 2–3 projects to increase my velocity. Every agent PR is verified against production evidence before merge, under the agent guidance and PR workflow I wrote for the team.

brightwheel · early-education software

Staff Software Engineer **Feb. 2020 – May 2024**

Promoted from Senior Software Engineer, Jan. 2023

- Led the team that rebuilt the education product from the ground up, replacing its entire legacy structure, migrating all customers, and supporting both old and new lesson plans.
- Designed and built the new system, shaping how educators create lessons, and shipped on time despite substantially shifting requirements.

- Sole backend engineer on a greenfield Marketplace, from concept to launch, working directly with product and design. Built geocoding and location search on PostGIS.
- Designed the data model and API to integrate an acquired company's curriculum alongside existing learning features, and migrated its content.
- Began modernizing the purchase flow for a 30-year-old curriculum business, integrating BigCommerce, Stripe, and other third-party APIs behind a new e-commerce frontend.
- Designed and built the original greenfield "flexible form" product that daycare applications run on, on a 250k RPM Rails application; the team has since extended it.
- Cut CI build times of one codebase 90% by optimizing the Next.js and CircleCI pipelines.
- Ran the system-design interview and gave feedback on its rubric and technical challenge, helping shape engineering hiring. Set backend priorities, led design reviews, and mentored engineers.
- Investigated production database stalls and implemented statement timeouts to prevent them, mitigated card-testing attacks with IP blocking and AWS WAF rules, and manually scaled Kubernetes capacity during traffic spikes until autoscaling replaced it.

Jellyvision · benefits decision-support software

Senior Software Engineer **Dec. 2016 – Feb. 2020**

Promoted from Software Engineer, Apr. 2019

- Co-owned the Ruby on Rails API behind ALEX, a conversational benefits counselor, handling up to 20M requests a day.
- Led a three-person team that built a "doctor finder" feature from requirements, integrating third-party APIs. Mentored teammates in TypeScript on the Node and React stack.
- Migrated a page from an in-house, Angular-style framework to React, making it render 5x faster.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Ruby & Rails: Ruby, Ruby on Rails, Sidekiq, graphql-ruby, RSpec, Minitest, Sorbet

APIs & messaging: GraphQL, gRPC/protobuf, REST, Kafka, SQS

Data: PostgreSQL (PostGIS), MySQL, Redis, BigQuery, SQL

Payments & e-commerce: Stripe, Braintree, Razorpay, BigCommerce

Infrastructure: Kubernetes, Docker, GCP, AWS, CircleCI

Monitoring: Datadog, New Relic, Grafana, Bugsnag

JavaScript: TypeScript, JavaScript, Node.js, React

AI tooling: parallel multi-agent workflows (pi, herdr); Claude, GPT, and other models chosen per task

EDUCATION

Loyola University Chicago — Master of Education (M.Ed.), 2015

University of California, Santa Cruz — BA, Mathematics, 2011

Dev Bootcamp — Immersive web development (Ruby on Rails), 2016